Personal statement:
I am a transfer student from Wilbur Wright College who is very excited to attend UIC. My experience at Wilbur Wright helped me become more social. I met many great and intelligent people who shared similar goals and interests through classes, clubs, and general public areas on campus. I built strong relationships based on shared passions, such as music, chess, and engineering. I look forward to attending UIC and meeting new people among the 37,000 students enrolled there. Beyond the people I will meet, I am also excited about the classes I will be taking. Finally, after two years of college, I will be taking more specialized, focused courses.

I feel that my time at Wilbur Wright prepared me well for the rigorous coursework ahead. The difficulty of my classes made effective study habits a necessity. I discovered that what works best for me is reviewing class materials with other students, alongside dedicated solo time to go through lecture notes and textbooks to gain a deeper understanding of the subjects. Rather than relying on the memorization of problem solutions, I test my understanding of core concepts, rather than just nominal values. By reinterpreting questions and merging concepts from different problems. During these study sessions, I enjoy listening to music. I remember tuning into UIC Radio and finding their selection of songs both engaging and enjoyable, and I hope to get more involved with the music scene at UIC.

I have played guitar for eight years, starting when I was twelve. While I have always had an interest in music, hearing the Beatles play guitar was what truly inspired me to pick up the instrument myself. I find music to be a deeply rewarding cognitive and social task. Learning new songs is challenging both mentally and physically. Reading sheet music used to feel like deciphering alien text, but translating those dots and lines into audible music makes all the effort worthwhile. There are also complex finger movements that make me wish I had longer, more flexible hands; yet, despite these inherent hurdles, carefully observing my technique and discovering how different physical approaches make difficult passages possible constantly surprises me. Lately, I have been enjoying playing flamenco and classical music from artists like Paco de Lucía and Isaac Albéniz. Playing music with others can be a bit anxiety-inducing and requires careful communication, but once that connection between musicians is established, it becomes a fantastic mutual experience.

I used to think my interest in music was nothing more than a hobby, but I have recently realized how much overlap exists between my music and engineering skills. The metacognition involved in analyzing what I am doing wrong when learning a song directly resembles trying to figure out why my approach to analyzing a circuit isn't working. In both cases, self-reflection helps me realize that my approach needs to change to achieve the desired result. Reading music is much like working through textbook chapters, taking notes, and translating concepts into true understanding. Similarly, discussing song structures and chord sequences with fellow musicians is just like collaborating with a classmate on lab goals and project guidelines.

program of choice:
My interest in Electrical Engineering started from immature reasons but has evolved into reasons that I now find valid. In early high school, I was really fascinated by pop science and almost pseudoscience. As I progressed through my education, I began to mature and focus more on actual physics, like classical mechanics and electromagnetism. This education made me reevaluate my beliefs and guided me to meaningful interests that would give me a real understanding of the physical world.

I really got into electronics through my interest in music. I have worked on the electronics of my guitar to get a sound like the music I like. My very first project was changing the pickups of my guitar, which through electromagnetic phenomena, turns the vibrations of strings into an electrical current that is then converted into audible sound by an amplifier. It was a very daunting task, as it was my first time soldering and working with a lot of thermal mass from the potentiometers of the guitar. Being able to successfully change the electronic components of my guitar gave me the confidence to work on more projects.

I've gotten old, broken amplifiers and worked with the PCBs' broken components, like failing input jacks. As I gained more electronic-technician experience through audio equipment, I started to gain an interest in designing my own audio equipment, such as effect pedals that alter the signal coming from the guitar and give it a significant change in timbre and tone. I explored free PCB design software, such as KiCad, and circuit simulation, such as LTspice. It was at this point where I realized this hobby changed from technician-like work into actual engineering, involving circuit analysis, wave mechanics, and even microcontroller programming.

Researching books and topics that I needed to understand to make more advanced electronic audio equipment led me to find other kinds of projects beyond audio. Embedded systems were what caught my attention the most. I find it to be the implementation of logic that interacts with the real world through designing specialized electronic equipment to hold the software that dictates the logic of the system. I can see good career prospects with embedded systems.

It is impossible to ignore the impact that AI is going to have across all domains. I feel that at the present time, learning the fundamentals of engineering is all the more important because we are now able to perform cognitive tasks that would require an entire team of humans to do. I always thought having autonomy in projects was nice but unrealistic, but now with AI, I see it as more probable than impossible and an opportunity to create a company or project that would have an impact on the world. I feel an urgency to learn, given how fast AI is advancing. I see UIC as the perfect place to learn engineering fundamentals and to secure a place in the advancement of AI where I am not behind or lacking in technical knowledge and experience.

There is so much more to electrical engineering than just electronics. In the 2025 spring semester at Wilbur Wright, I had a seminar class where Professor Dr. Igor Paprotny gave a presentation on MEMS technology. One detail of his presentation that struck me the most was how nature inspires their technological design; I remember the propulsion mechanism for a MEMS design was inspired by an insect flapping its wings.